

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

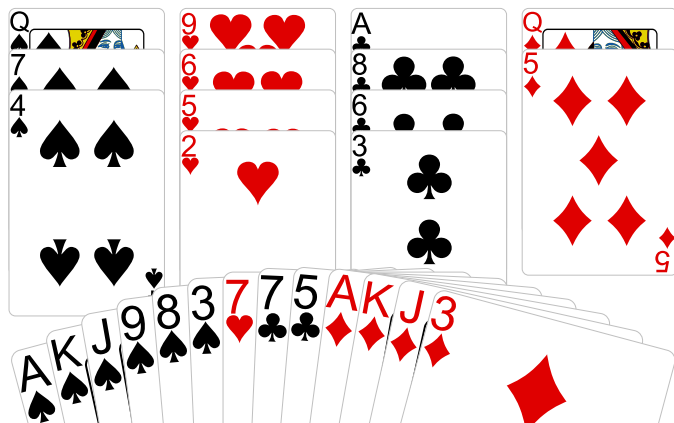
Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

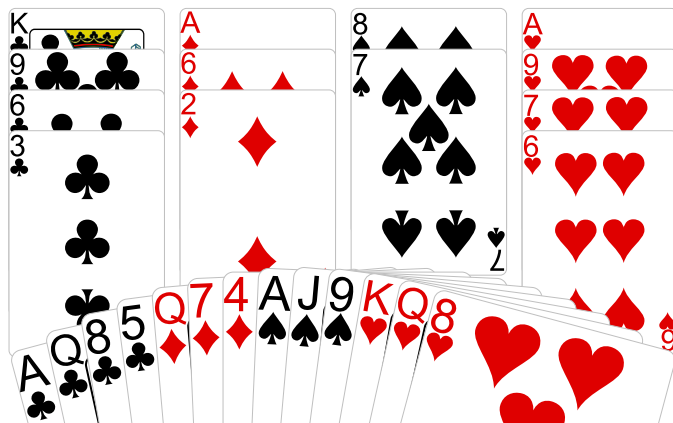
- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 2
 ♥ A J T 8
 ♦ 9 8 4 2
 ♣ Q J 4

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5



♠ T 6
 ♥ K Q 4 3
 ♦ T 7 6
 ♣ K T 9 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

EAST's 1 ♥ opening is passed around to NORTH. He is tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points SOUTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2 ♣.

NORTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

SOUTH raises to 4 ♠.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ A 9 7 6
 ♦ A 6 2
 ♣ K 9 6 3

♠ T 6 5 3

♥ J T 4

♦ K T 9 5

♣ T 2



♠ A J 9
 ♥ K Q 8
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q 8 5

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 3

♣ J 7 4

EAST has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

WEST bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When EAST denies holding a 4-card Major WEST has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since EAST promised he had the suit controlled.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	1NT	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A T 8
 ♦ T 5 4 3
 ♣ 9 5 3

♠ J T 5 2

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ 8 6

♣ J 8 6



♠ 9 7 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ K Q 2

♣ A T 7 2

♠ A 8 6

♥ K Q J

♦ A J 9 7

♣ K Q 4

SOUTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

NORTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming SOUTH wants to hear his best suit.

SOUTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. NORTH passes, of course.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
All Pass			
1NT by South			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q T

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6

♠ T 9 3

♥ K J 8 4

♦ T 4 2

♣ Q J T



♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ 9 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 5 3 2

WEST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

EAST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

In theory WEST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Dbl	Pass	2♠	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 4
 ♣ K Q 6 3

♠ A Q T 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q T

♣ A 9 7 4



♠ 9 6

♥ K J T 9

♦ A 7 6 5

♣ T 8 5

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points NORTH should overcall 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If NORTH had opened, SOUTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since NORTH overcalled, SOUTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

NORTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 6 4

♥ J T 7 5

♦ 6

♣ A K J 3

♠ A 5 2

♥ A 3

♦ K J 8 3

♣ Q 8 7 4



♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 9 8 6 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 9 5

♠ T 9 8 7

♥ 2

♦ Q T 9 7 4

♣ T 6 2

WEST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦.
But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with
perfect distribution.

EAST has 13 points and only wants to play in one
contract, 4♥.

WEST passes happily.

West

North

East

South

1♦

Dbl

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East